Business Insights & CEO Recommendations

NORTHWIND SALES & BUSINESS PERFORMANCE ANALYSIS

Parts 7 and 8 | Techie Academy Capstone Project

Evidence base: Northwind Power BI report screenshots shared during analysis. Amounts marked "approximately" are read from rounded visuals, not a database export.

Executive summary

Across the available historical order data, Northwind recorded approximately $1.35 million in revenue from 830 orders, with an average order value around $1,630. Revenue is concentrated in important products, customers and markets; shipping records indicate high dispatch timeliness, with some exceptions requiring investigation. The recommendations below prioritize monitoring, comparison and targeted review rather than unsupported claims about profitability or causation.

Performance snapshot

Metric	Observed result
Revenue / orders	Approximately $1.35M / 830
Average order value	Approximately $1.63K
Customers / products / categories	93 / 77 / 8
Top revenue product	Côte de Blaye (approximately $150K)
Highest-revenue market	USA
Shipped on time / late / no shipped date	772 / 37 / 21

Insight 01 | Sales performance and reporting periods

What happened? Northwind generated approximately $1.35M in revenue across 830 orders. The 1997 calendar-year bar is the highest (about $0.66M), while April has the highest aggregated revenue across the available April observations (about $190K).

Why it matters Annual totals are not a like-for-like growth comparison because 1996 and 1998 are only partially represented. The month chart also aggregates the same calendar month across years.

Recommendation Use month-by-month sales, order counts and average order values; compare equivalent periods and investigate the products and markets behind peaks before setting forecasts.

Insight 02 | Product and category mix

What happened? Côte de Blaye is the highest-revenue product (approximately $150K), while Camembert Pierrot leads by units sold. Beverages produces the highest category revenue, followed by Dairy Products; eight products are flagged as discontinued.

Why it matters Unit volume and revenue identify different product strengths. The available visuals do not measure cost or profit margins, so highest revenue does not establish highest profitability.

Recommendation Monitor high-revenue and high-volume products separately; compare inventory with sales velocity, check replacements for discontinued lines, and review prices only alongside demand and cost evidence.

Insight 03 | Customers and geographic markets

What happened? The customer table contains 93 customers. The USA leads revenue, followed by Germany and Austria. QUICK-Stop generates about $117.48K, slightly ahead of Save-a-lot Markets at about $115.67K; Save-a-lot Markets places more orders.

Why it matters Frequent ordering is not identical to high spend. Major customers and markets deserve attention, although the charts alone do not prove retention risk or quantify market dependence.

Recommendation Monitor high-value customers for changes in frequency and average order value. Prioritize service in the strongest markets and evaluate lower-revenue markets before investing in expansion.

Insight 04 | Employee-associated sales performance

What happened? Margaret leads employee-associated revenue at approximately $250.19K (18.47% of total in the displayed breakdown) and handled approximately 156 orders. Robert has the highest average order value, around $1,950.

Why it matters Sales outcomes differ by orders handled and value per order. These figures alone cannot establish individual productivity because customer assignments, tenure and workload may differ.

Recommendation Use a balanced review of revenue, order count, average order value, customers served and comparable time periods. Investigate the reasons behind high order values before adopting any sales practice more broadly.

Insight 05 | Shipping reliability and freight costs

What happened? Of 830 orders, 772 have shipped dates on or before the recorded required dates, 37 were later, and 21 have no shipped date. United Package handled the most orders and shows the highest total freight.

Why it matters This gives 93.01% recorded on-time against all orders, or about 95.43% of the 809 orders with shipped dates. The comparison is between ShippedDate and RequiredDate, not actual delivery timestamps. Larger freight totals can reflect more shipments.

Recommendation Review the 37 late records and 21 orders with missing shipped dates. Compare carriers using per-order freight and on-time proportions, and examine destinations where delays or cost levels justify attention.

Prioritized CEO action plan

Priority	Action	How to evaluate
1 | Reporting	Standardize comparable monthly sales reporting	Revenue, orders and average order value by equivalent periods
2 | Customer	Review and retain highest-value accounts	Revenue, repeat order frequency and account trends
3 | Operations	Investigate exceptions and carrier cost efficiency	Late/missing shipping records; average freight per order
4 | Product	Align stock reviews with sales volume and revenue	Inventory vs recent units sold; discontinued-item replacements
5 | Workforce	Use balanced employee-associated sales indicators	Orders, revenue, AOV and comparable assignment/time context

Interpretation and evidence notes

- All figures are from user-shared Power BI screenshots and should be confirmed against the final refreshed PBIX before presentation.
- The 19.05% shown for QUICK-Stop in the customer pie chart is a share of the top-ten customers displayed, not a share of all-company revenue.
- The current data visualizations do not establish profitability, actual delivery arrival dates, reasons for discontinuation, or causal explanations for sales peaks.
- The business-case PDF requests 5–10 meaningful insights and evidence-based recommendations. These five findings meet the lower end of that guidance.

Source: Techie Academy Capstone Project, “Northwind Sales & Business Performance Analysis,” Parts 7–8; Power BI Northwind report screenshots provided in the project conversation.